

MODULE

1

Becoming Yourself

"Experience is the teacher of all things."

— JULIUS CAESAR

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How do your experiences help shape your identity?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1 **Flora & Ulysses: The Illuminated Adventures** · Kate DiCamillo FANTASY

2 **Lend a Hand: Poems About Giving** · John Frank NARRATIVE POETRY

3 **The Year of the Rat** · Grace Lin REALISTIC FICTION

4 **Kitoto the Mighty** · Tololwa M. Mollel FOLKTALE

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B · Reading Comprehension (32)	p. 6
C · IB Critical Thinking (5)	p. 12
D · MAP Practice (20)	p. 15

NAME _____ DATE _____



Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 1 · Becoming Yourself · Grade 4 · 30 Items

CCSS L.4.4 · L.4.5 · L.4.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.4.6

identity

Your **identity** is —

- ☐ A. the language and accent you happen to speak with.
- ☐ B. what other people think of you, or your reputation.
- ☐ C. who you are — the qualities and beliefs that make you yourself.
- ☐ D. the age and height written on your records.

Q2 L.4.6

wisdom

If you have **wisdom**, you —

- ☐ A. are able to use your experience to make good decisions.
- ☐ B. can recite many facts and figures from memory.
- ☐ C. are clever at winning arguments with others.
- ☐ D. are simply older than everyone around you.

Q3 L.4.6

experience

Your **experience** is —

- ☐ A. a plan for what you will do tomorrow.
- ☐ B. made up of the events you have lived through and the feelings you have had.
- ☐ C. the skills you were born already knowing.
- ☐ D. the things you hope will happen to you someday.

Q4 L.4.6

pursuit

A **pursuit** is —

- ☐ **A.** a wish you make but never act on.
- ☐ **B.** a reward you are handed for winning.
- ☐ **C.** a break you take to rest from work.
- ☐ **D.** something you work hard to do or accomplish.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · FLORA & ULYSSES

Q5 L.4.5

TRAP

cynic

Flora called herself a "natural-born **cynic**." A **cynic** is —

- ☐ **A.** someone who always expects bad things to happen.
- ☐ **B.** someone who tells funny jokes all day.
- ☐ **C.** someone who reads only true stories.
- ☐ **D.** someone who is usually cheerful and hopeful.

Q6 L.4.4

defiance

Flora lived in **defiance** of contracts. If you act in **defiance**, you —

- ☐ **A.** ask permission before you act.
- ☐ **B.** follow every rule exactly.
- ☐ **C.** know something is not allowed but you do it anyway.
- ☐ **D.** quietly agree with whatever you are told.

Q7 L.4.5

TRAP

profound

Ulysses had a **profound** thought. A **profound** thought is one that is —

- ☐ **A.** spoken in a very loud voice.
- ☐ **B.** deep and full of meaning.
- ☐ **C.** simple and easy for anyone to understand.
- ☐ **D.** silly and not worth thinking about.

Q8 L.4.4

inadvertently

If you did something **inadvertently**, you did it —

- ☐ A. on purpose, after planning it for a long time.
- ☐ B. in a hurry, just to get it over with.
- ☐ C. again, for the second time.
- ☐ D. by mistake, without realizing it.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · FLORA & ULYSSES (CONTINUED)

Q9 L.4.5 TRAP

consumed

The squirrel had **consumed** a great deal of food. If you **consumed** something, you —

- ☐ A. ate or drank it.
- ☐ B. bought it at a store.
- ☐ C. hid it in a safe place.
- ☐ D. gave it away to a friend.

Q10 L.4.4

descended

A swarm of locusts **descended** on the field. If something **descended**, it —

- ☐ A. rose straight up into the sky.
- ☐ B. spread out across the ground.
- ☐ C. came down from a higher place.
- ☐ D. stayed completely still.

Q11 L.4.4

obliged

When Flora asked the squirrel to breathe, the squirrel **obliged**. If you **obliged**, you —

- ☐ A. refused to do what was asked.
- ☐ B. did what you were asked or expected to do.
- ☐ C. ran away as fast as you could.
- ☐ D. asked for help from someone else.

Q12 L.4.5 TRAP

mundane

A vacuum cleaner is a **mundane** object. Something that is **mundane** is —

- ☐ A. wet and slippery to touch.
- ☐ B. rare, exciting, and special.
- ☐ C. ordinary and often dull.
- ☐ D. strange and hard to believe.

Q13 L.4.4

considered

Ulysses **considered** both of them carefully. If you **considered** something, you —

- ☐ A. decided about it without thinking.
- ☐ B. ignored it completely.
- ☐ C. guessed about it quickly.
- ☐ D. thought about it carefully.

Q14 L.4.5 TRAP

disdain

They treated the squirrel with **disdain**. If you treat someone with **disdain**, you —

- ☐ A. show that you think the person is not worth respect.
- ☐ B. treat the person with deep respect and admiration.
- ☐ C. feel jealous of the person.
- ☐ D. feel afraid of the person at all times.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · LEND A HAND

Q15 L.4.4

motioned

The boy **motioned** toward the empty seat. If someone **motioned**, they —

- ☐ A. shouted as loudly as they could.
- ☐ B. directed someone with hand gestures or body movements.
- ☐ C. whispered a secret in their ear.
- ☐ D. drew a picture to explain.

Q16 L.4.4

treasure

The children uncovered a **treasure**: a beautiful stream. A **treasure** is —

- ☐ **A.** a pile of gold and jewels, and nothing else.
- ☐ **B.** a map showing where riches are buried.
- ☐ **C.** anything that a person values or feels is precious.
- ☐ **D.** something old that has been thrown away.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE YEAR OF THE RAT

Q17 L.4.4

resolutions

Pacy made New Year's **resolutions**. **Resolutions** are —

- ☐ **A.** promises to do or not do something.
- ☐ **B.** wishes you hope will come true on their own.
- ☐ **C.** rules that your parents make for you.
- ☐ **D.** memories of things you did last year.

Q18 L.4.4

doubts

Pacy had **doubts** about her dream. If you have **doubts**, you —

- ☐ **A.** are completely certain about it.
- ☐ **B.** are not sure about something.
- ☐ **C.** are excited and cannot wait for it.
- ☐ **D.** have completely forgotten about it.

Q19 L.4.5

TRAP

relying

When you are **relying** on someone, you are —

- ☐ **A.** hiding away from the person.
- ☐ **B.** doing everything yourself, without their help.
- ☐ **C.** trusting or depending on that person.
- ☐ **D.** competing against the person to win.

Q20 L.4.5 TRAP

clumsy

Pacy felt that her drawing was **clumsy**. If an action is **clumsy**, it —

- ☐ **A.** is done in a graceful, skillful way.
- ☐ **B.** is done neatly and with great care.
- ☐ **C.** is done slowly and steadily.
- ☐ **D.** happens in an awkward, careless way.

Q21 L.4.4

awkward

There was an **awkward** silence in the room. In an **awkward** situation, things feel —

- ☐ **A.** tense and uncomfortable.
- ☐ **B.** calm and relaxing.
- ☐ **C.** friendly and welcoming.
- ☐ **D.** happy and cheerful.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · KITOTO THE MIGHTY

Q22 L.4.4

cautiously

Kitoto crept forward **cautiously**. If you do something **cautiously**, you do it —

- ☐ **A.** in a hurry, without looking.
- ☐ **B.** carefully, to avoid danger.
- ☐ **C.** boldly, without any fear.
- ☐ **D.** carelessly, without paying attention.

Q23 L.4.4

trickle

A **trickle** of water ran down the rock. A **trickle** is —

- ☐ **A.** a wide, rushing river.
- ☐ **B.** a large, deep lake.
- ☐ **C.** a small amount of slowly flowing liquid.
- ☐ **D.** a heavy fall of rain.

Q24 L.4.4

marveled

Kitoto **marveled** at the great mountain. If you **marveled** at something, you —

- ☐ A. were bored by it.
- ☐ B. were angry about it.
- ☐ C. were too tired to notice it.
- ☐ D. were surprised or amazed by it.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · KITOTO THE MIGHTY (CONTINUED)

Q25 L.4.4

mighty

Kitoto called himself "the **Mighty**." Something that is **mighty** is —

- ☐ A. strong and powerful.
- ☐ B. soft and gentle.
- ☐ C. small and quiet.
- ☐ D. old and slow.

Q26 L.4.4

distant

The wind swung Kitoto to a **distant** peak. If something is **distant**, it is —

- ☐ A. very close by.
- ☐ B. far away.
- ☐ C. easy to reach in a moment.
- ☐ D. hidden just out of sight.

Q27 L.4.4

proclaimed

Kitoto **proclaimed** that he was the master of the Savannah. If you **proclaimed** something, you —

- ☐ A. whispered it so no one could hear.
- ☐ B. mumbled it under your breath.
- ☐ C. said it in a strong way to show it was important.
- ☐ D. asked it as a quiet question.

Q28 L.4.4

majestic

The mountain was **majestic**. Something that is **majestic** is —

- ☐ **A.** small and easy to miss.
- ☐ **B.** dull and gray.
- ☐ **C.** broken into pieces.
- ☐ **D.** impressive and beautiful.

Q29 L.4.5 **TRAP**

sumptuous

Kigego's home looked **sumptuous**. Something that is **sumptuous** is —

- ☐ **A.** impressive and expensive-looking.
- ☐ **B.** empty and plain.
- ☐ **C.** cheap and poorly made.
- ☐ **D.** old and falling apart.

Q30 L.4.5 **TRAP**

hoard

The mouse kept a **hoard** deep inside the mountain. A **hoard** is —

- ☐ **A.** a large crowd of noisy people.
- ☐ **B.** a group of valuable things kept secret and carefully guarded.
- ☐ **C.** a single coin that has been lost.
- ☐ **D.** a gift you give away to others.



Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 1 · Becoming Yourself · Grade 4 · 32 Items

CCSS RL.4.1 · RL.4.2 · RL.4.3 · RL.4.5 · RL.4.6 · RI.4.1 · RI.4.2 · RI.4.3

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · Flora & Ulysses: The Illuminated Adventures

FANTASY · KATE DICAMILLO / K.G. CAMPBELL · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.4.2

What is this part of the story mostly about?

- ☐ A. A girl who gives up reading comics to please her mother.
- ☐ B. A cynical girl named Flora who saves a squirrel that becomes extraordinary.
- ☐ C. A woman whose new vacuum cleaner runs wild in her yard.
- ☐ D. A squirrel that learns to gather food for the winter.

Q2 RL.4.3

Why is Flora ignoring her mother at the start?

- ☐ A. She is reading a comic book, and her mother wants her to read "true literature" instead.
- ☐ B. Her mother asked her to clean her room.
- ☐ C. Her mother told her to go outside and play.
- ☐ D. She is upset that her mother writes romance novels.

Q3 RL.4.3

What does Flora see happening in Mrs. Tickham's backyard?

- ☐ A. Mrs. Tickham is planting a new garden.
- ☐ B. A jet plane has really landed on the grass.
- ☐ C. Mrs. Tickham is washing her car in the driveway.
- ☐ D. A runaway vacuum cleaner is chasing around the yard toward a squirrel.

Q4 RL.4.3

How does Flora save the squirrel after the vacuum sucks it up?

- ☐ A. She calls a veterinarian for help.
- ☐ B. She feeds it nuts until it wakes up.
- ☐ C. She breathes into its mouth and pushes on its chest, and the squirrel obliges and breathes again.
- ☐ D. She wraps it in a warm blanket.

Q5 RL.4.3

How does the squirrel change after it is brought back to life?

- ☐ A. Its mind feels larger and full of meaning, and it gains surprising strength and understanding.
- ☐ B. It becomes afraid of Flora and runs away forever.
- ☐ C. It grows much larger than a normal squirrel.
- ☐ D. It forgets how to climb trees.

Q6 RL.4.6

Flora imagines her own words floating above her head in a comic-strip bubble. What does this detail show about her point of view?

- ☐ A. She is bored and wants something exciting to happen.
- ☐ B. She does not really understand how comics work.
- ☐ C. She is planning to draw her own comic book.
- ☐ D. She loves comics so much that she sees her own life through them.

Q7 RL.4.5

This selection mixes comic-book panels with all-capital dialogue and regular prose. How does this structure help the story?

- ☐ A. It hides the ending until the very last line.
- ☐ B. It tells the story backward, from end to beginning.
- ☐ C. It lets the reader feel both the action of a comic and the inside thoughts of the characters.
- ☐ D. It turns the whole story into a rhyming poem.

Q8 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is a MAIN theme, or message, of this part of *Flora & Ulysses*?

- ☐ A. Flora signed a contract promising to read true literature.
- ☐ B. Even someone who expects the worst can be changed by an unexpected experience and act with courage and care.
- ☐ C. Mrs. Tickham got a powerful new vacuum for her birthday.
- ☐ D. Flora reads comic books about a hero named Incandesto.

Selection 2 · Lend a Hand: Poems About Giving

NARRATIVE POETRY · JOHN FRANK / LONDON LADD · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RL.4.2

What do the poems in "Lend a Hand" mostly have in common?

- ☐ A. Each poem is about a child who feels lonely at school.
- ☐ B. Each poem describes a meal that a family shares.
- ☐ C. Each poem shows a young person giving time, kindness, or help to someone else.
- ☐ D. Each poem tells about an animal that needs help.

Q10 RL.4.3

In "Jammin'," who is the narrator's new friend?

- ☐ A. Mr. Kellerman, an eighty-year-old neighbor the narrator calls "K-man."
- ☐ B. A classmate the same age as the narrator.
- ☐ C. A famous musician on the radio.
- ☐ D. The narrator's older brother.

Q11 RL.4.3

In "Sandwich," what does the narrator do for the new kid eating alone?

- ☐ A. Buys the new kid a whole new lunch.
- ☐ B. Walks away to sit with other friends.
- ☐ C. Asks the teacher to move the new kid's seat.
- ☐ D. Hands the new kid half of the sandwich, and still feels full afterward.

Q12 RL.4.3

In "Bus Ride," how does the narrator help the person who gets on the bus?

- ☐ A. By giving the person money for the fare.
- ☐ B. By catching the person's eye and motioning toward the empty seat.
- ☐ C. By helping the person carry heavy bags.
- ☐ D. By singing a song to cheer the person up.

Q13 RL.4.3

In "Stream," what do the children uncover as they work together?

- ☐ A. A chest of gold coins buried in the mud.
- ☐ B. An old map leading to a cave.
- ☐ C. A beautiful stream, hidden under all the cans they pick up — a real treasure.
- ☐ D. A nest of baby birds in the grass.

Q14 RL.4.5

"Lend a Hand" is a collection of separate poems rather than one long story. How does this structure help the reader?

- ☐ A. It keeps all the events in one single place and time.
- ☐ B. It shows many different ways to give, each through a different person's small story.
- ☐ C. It lists the poems in the order they were written.
- ☐ D. It hides the topic of each poem until the end.

Q15 RL.4.6

Most of the poems are told by a young narrator using the word "I." How does this first-person point of view affect the poems?

- ☐ A. It lets the reader feel the narrator's own thoughts and feelings about helping others.
- ☐ B. It makes the poems read like a list of rules.
- ☐ C. It hides how the narrator feels about giving.
- ☐ D. It proves the events could not really happen.

Q16 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN message, or theme, of "Lend a Hand: Poems About Giving"?

- ☐ A. Mr. Kellerman, the narrator's friend, is eighty years old.
- ☐ B. The narrator shared half of a sandwich with a new kid.
- ☐ C. A scout troop picked up cans and uncovered a stream.
- ☐ D. Giving time, effort, and kindness to others helps both the giver and the receiver feel fuller.

Selection 3 · The Year of the Rat

REALISTIC FICTION · GRACE LIN / QU LAN · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.4.2

What is "The Year of the Rat" mostly about?

- ☐ A. How Pacy and her friend Melody spend Chinese New Year together.
- ☐ B. A girl who is angry that a new boy moved into her friend's old house.
- ☐ C. A family that moves across the country to California.
- ☐ D. A girl named Pacy who learns to be brave and to decide who she is and what she wants to become.

Q18 RL.4.3

What dream does Pacy have for her future?

- ☐ A. To become a famous athlete.
- ☐ B. To become a doctor like her father.
- ☐ C. To become an author and illustrator.
- ☐ D. To move back to California with Melody.

Q19 RL.4.3

What does Dad tell Pacy about deciding who she is?

- ☐ A. That no one can tell her — only she can decide, because only she knows who she is.
- ☐ B. That her teacher should decide for her.
- ☐ C. That she is too young to decide anything.
- ☐ D. That she should wait until she is grown up.

Q20 RL.4.3

How does Pacy stand up for Dun-Wei at school?

- ☐ A. She writes a note to the principal about him.
- ☐ B. She tells the others it is not nice to call him "Dumb-Way," because his name is Dun-Wei.
- ☐ C. She invites him to her house for dinner.
- ☐ D. She moves to a different desk to sit near him.

Q21 RL.4.6

The story is told by Pacy using the word "I." How does this first-person point of view help the reader?

- ☐ A. It keeps Pacy's feelings hidden from the reader.
- ☐ B. It tells the story from Dad's point of view instead.
- ☐ C. It makes the reader believe the story is a folktale.
- ☐ D. It lets the reader hear Pacy's private doubts and her growing courage from the inside.

Q22 RL.4.5

Dad tells Pacy the story "Knowing the Fish" inside the main story. What is this kind of story-within-a-story called, and why is it included?

- ☐ A. An embedded story; it teaches Pacy a lesson that fits her own situation.
- ☐ B. A title page; it names the book.
- ☐ C. A glossary; it lists hard words.
- ☐ D. An index; it shows where to find facts.

Q23 RL.4.3

By the end, how has Pacy changed?

- ☐ A. She decides to give up her dream for good.
- ☐ B. She feels brave, "like a tiger," and trusts that she can decide her own future.
- ☐ C. She moves away to be with her best friend.
- ☐ D. She decides she no longer wants any friends.

Q24 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN message, or theme, of "The Year of the Rat"?

- ☐ A. Pacy's best friend Melody moved away to California.
- ☐ B. Pacy was born in the Year of the Tiger.
- ☐ C. Only you can decide who you are, and you can be brave enough to change the things you do not like.
- ☐ D. Dun-Wei's family moved into Melody's old house.

Selection 4 · Kitoto the Mighty

FOLKTALE · TOLOLWA M. MOLLEL / KRISTI FROST · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.4.2

What is "Kitoto the Mighty" mostly about?

- ☐ A. How a hawk hunts the animals of the Savannah.
- ☐ B. How the wind, sun, and river decide who is strongest.
- ☐ C. A small mouse who looks for the most powerful being to protect him and learns the truth about power.
- ☐ D. How a mouse named Kigego carved a mountain with her teeth.

Q26 RL.4.3

Why does Kitoto go searching for the most powerful being?

- ☐ A. He wants to become the ruler of the Savannah.
- ☐ B. He is looking for food to store for the winter.
- ☐ C. He is trying to find his way back home.
- ☐ D. He wants a powerful friend to protect him from the hawk that nearly caught him.

Q27 RL.4.3

In what order does Kitoto ask the beings about who is most powerful?

- ☐ A. The mountain, then the wind, then the sun, then the river.
- ☐ B. The river, then the sun, then the wind, then the mountain.
- ☐ C. The hawk, then the river, then the mountain, then the sun.
- ☐ D. The wind, then the sun, then the river, then the mountain.

Q28 **RL.4.3**

Who turns out to be the "most powerful being" the mountain points Kitoto to?

- ☐ **A.** Kigego, a mountain mouse who carved the tunnels with her own teeth.
- ☐ **B.** The hawk that hunts in the sky.
- ☐ **C.** The sun that lights the Savannah.
- ☐ **D.** A giant beast no one has ever seen.

Q29 **RL.4.3**

What does Kitoto learn from meeting Kigego?

- ☐ **A.** That the hawk is the strongest creature of all.
- ☐ **B.** That even a small mouse can be mighty through hard work, just as Kigego carved a whole mountain.
- ☐ **C.** That he should never leave his bush again.
- ☐ **D.** That the mountain is alive and can speak.

Q30 **RL.4.6**

Each time Kitoto meets a new being, he gives himself a grander title — "the Mighty," then "the Great," then "the Magnificent." What does this repeated pattern show about Kitoto?

- ☐ **A.** That he has truly become a king.
- ☐ **B.** That he has many different names.
- ☐ **C.** That he is a small mouse trying to seem braver and more important than he feels.
- ☐ **D.** That he forgets who he is.

Q31 **RL.4.5**

Kitoto repeats almost the same question to the river, the sun, the wind, and the mountain. How does this repeated pattern help the folktale?

- ☐ **A.** It makes the folktale sound like a funny song.
- ☐ **B.** It explains the rules for a game the animals play.
- ☐ **C.** It shows that each being is angry at the next one.
- ☐ **D.** It builds the journey step by step and leads the reader to the surprise that the smallest creature is mighty.

Q32 **RL.4.2** **TRAP**

What is the MAIN message, or theme, of "Kitoto the Mighty"?

- ☐ **A.** Size does not decide power; even the smallest creature can be mighty through hard work and courage.
- ☐ **B.** A hawk circled high above the Savannah.
- ☐ **C.** The wind swung Kitoto to a distant mountain peak.
- ☐ **D.** Kigego built all her tunnels with her own teeth.



Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 1 · Becoming Yourself · Grade 4

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about how our experiences shape who we are. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1

Causation

DOK 3

In "**Flora & Ulysses**," one experience **CHANGES** everything. Show what the squirrel was like **BEFORE**, what **HAPPENED** to it, and what it became **AFTER**.

BEFORE → EVENT → AFTER · FLORA & ULYSSES

THE SQUIRREL BEFORE

WHAT HAPPENED

THE SQUIRREL AFTER

How does this one experience also begin to change Flora, the "natural-born cynic"? Explain.

In "**Lend a Hand**," young people **CHOOSE** to help others. Trace **THREE** moments of giving: who gives, what they give, and how it makes them feel.

ACTS OF GIVING · LEND A HAND

POEM 1 · "SANDWICH"

what is shared, and how does it feel?

POEM 2 · "BUS RIDE"

what is given to a stranger?

POEM 3 · "STREAM"

what do the children give their effort to?

What do these poems show about how giving to others can shape the kind of person you are? Explain.

In **"The Year of the Rat,"** Pacy reflects on a hard question about her IDENTITY. Show her doubt at the START, what Dad teaches her, and how she changes by the END.

A CHANGE IN IDENTITY · THE YEAR OF THE RAT

PACY AT THE START

PACY BY THE END

Dad says only Pacy can decide who she is. Why does deciding for yourself matter when you are shaping your own identity?

Q4

Perspective

DOK 3

Two characters in this module learn that POWER and SIZE are not the same. Compare HOW "**Kitoto the Mighty**" and "**The Year of the Rat**" each show a small or unsure character discovering real strength.

DISCOVERING REAL STRENGTH

KITOTO · THE TINY MOUSE

PACY · THE UNSURE GIRL

What do both stories show about where real strength or power comes from? (Hint: not size or luck.)

Essential Question: How do your experiences help shape your identity? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

What experience does a character have, and how does it change who they are?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

What experience does a character have, and how does it change who they are?

MY BIG IDEA



Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 1 · Becoming Yourself · Grade 4

MAP RIT 200 → 220 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The New Boy's First Goal

Diego was the new boy at school, and he was sure he was no good at soccer. On his old team he had spent every game sitting on the bench. When his class went outside to play, his stomach felt tight. He stood at the edge of the field and hoped the ball would never come near him. But one boy named Theo waved him over. "Stand here," Theo said, pointing to an open spot. "I will pass to you." Diego shook his head. He was certain he would miss. Still, when the ball rolled toward him, he kicked as hard as he could. To his shock, the ball flew straight into the net. His new classmates cheered and slapped him on the back. Diego could not stop smiling. He had always believed he was a bad player. Now he wondered if maybe he had only needed someone to believe in him first. That one goal did not make him a star, but it changed the way he saw himself.

170 WORDS · LEXILE 500–560L · RIT 200–206

Q1

RIT 200

Lexile 500L

Key Detail

How did Diego feel about soccer at the start of the passage?

- ☐ A. He was sure he was no good at it.
- ☐ B. He thought he was the best on the team.
- ☐ C. He did not care about it at all.
- ☐ D. He had never played it before.

Q2

RIT 202

Lexile 520L

Key Detail

What did Theo do to include Diego?

- ☐ A. He gave Diego a new pair of shoes.
- ☐ B. He waved Diego over and said he would pass to him.
- ☐ C. He asked the teacher to put Diego on the bench.
- ☐ D. He told Diego to watch from the edge of the field.

Q3**RIT 203****Lexile 530L****Cause & Effect**

Why did Diego's classmates cheer?

- ☐ **A.** The game was finally over.
- ☐ **B.** Theo had scored the winning goal.
- ☐ **C.** Diego kicked the ball straight into the net.
- ☐ **D.** The teacher gave the class a prize.

Q4**RIT 205****Lexile 550L****Inference**

When Diego wondered if he had "only needed someone to believe in him first," it suggests that —

- ☐ **A.** he wanted to quit the team.
- ☐ **B.** he was angry at his old team.
- ☐ **C.** he still thought he was a bad player.
- ☐ **D.** a little encouragement helped him see his own ability.

Q5**RIT 206****Lexile 560L****Main Idea**

What is the BIG IDEA of "The New Boy's First Goal"?

- ☐ **A.** A new experience and a little support can change the way you see yourself.
- ☐ **B.** Soccer is the most important game played at school.
- ☐ **C.** A new student should always wait to be picked.
- ☐ **D.** You should only play sports you are already good at.

Passage 2 · Maria's Garden

Maria wanted to be good at something right away. When she tried the piano, she quit after a week because her fingers stumbled. When she tried painting, she gave up because her trees looked like green blobs. She believed that if she was not great at first, she never would be. Then her grandmother handed her a packet of seeds. "A garden teaches you who you are," Abuela said. Maria planted the seeds and watered them every morning. For many days nothing happened, and she almost stopped. But her grandmother told her that growing takes patience, and patience can be learned. Slowly, tiny green shoots pushed up through the soil. Maria was amazed. She had made these plants grow with her own steady care. As the weeks passed, she watched her garden bloom into bright rows of flowers and vegetables. Maria realized she was not a quitter after all. She had simply never given herself enough time. The garden had shown her that she could be patient, and that changed how she thought about everything she tried.

177 WORDS · LEXILE 560–620L · RIT 206–211

Q6 RIT 206 Lexile 560L Key Detail

Why did Maria quit the piano and painting?

- ☐ A. She ran out of time to practice.
- ☐ B. She was not great at them right away.
- ☐ C. Her grandmother told her to stop.
- ☐ D. She wanted to play soccer instead.

Q7 RIT 208 Lexile 580L Key Detail

What did Abuela give Maria?

- ☐ A. A new paintbrush.
- ☐ B. A piano book.
- ☐ C. A watering can.
- ☐ D. A packet of seeds.

Q8 RIT 209 Lexile 590L Cause & Effect

Why did the seeds finally grow into a garden?

- ☐ A. Maria watered them every morning with steady, patient care.
- ☐ B. Abuela planted new seeds for her.
- ☐ C. The weather suddenly turned warm.
- ☐ D. Maria bought plants that were already grown.

Q9 RIT 210 Lexile 600L Vocabulary

Abuela says "growing takes **patience**." **Patience** is —

- ☐ A. the need to finish things quickly.
- ☐ B. a sudden burst of energy.
- ☐ C. the ability to wait calmly without giving up.
- ☐ D. a feeling of being angry.

Q10 RIT 211 Lexile 620L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Maria's Garden"?

- ☐ A. A garden will grow well even without any care.
- ☐ B. An experience can teach you something true about yourself, like learning you can be patient.
- ☐ C. It is better to give up than to try something hard.
- ☐ D. Grandmothers always know the most about plants.

In a small village, a boy named Kofi longed to join the drumming circle. Every evening the older players gathered under the great tree and filled the night with rhythm. Kofi practiced in secret, but whenever he tried to copy the others exactly, his drumming sounded stiff and wrong. He grew discouraged and nearly hid his drum away for good. One night, an old drummer named Yaw noticed him. "You keep trying to sound like everyone else," Yaw said. "But a drummer must find his own beat." Kofi did not understand at first. The next evening, instead of copying, he closed his eyes and played the rhythm he felt inside — the beat of his own heart, the patter of rain he loved, the steps of his little sister dancing. The sound was different from the others, yet it fit perfectly, weaving through their rhythm like a new color. The circle smiled and welcomed him in. Kofi learned that he did not become a real drummer by imitating others. He found himself by daring to play the music that was truly his own.

183 WORDS · LEXILE 620–700L · RIT 211–216

Q11 RIT 211 Lexile 620L Key Detail

What did Kofi long to do?

- ☐ A. Plant a tree in the village.
- ☐ B. Teach his sister to dance.
- ☐ C. Join the village drumming circle.
- ☐ D. Build his own drum to sell.

Q12 RIT 212 Lexile 640L Cause & Effect

Why did Kofi's drumming sound "stiff and wrong" at first?

- ☐ A. He was only trying to copy the others exactly.
- ☐ B. His drum was cracked and broken.
- ☐ C. He practiced only in the daytime.
- ☐ D. The other players were too loud.

Q13 RIT 213 Lexile 660L Key Detail

What advice did the old drummer Yaw give Kofi?

- ☐ A. To practice only under the great tree.
- ☐ B. To play more quietly than the others.
- ☐ C. To hide his drum away for good.
- ☐ D. That a drummer must find his own beat.

Q14 RIT 215 Lexile 680L Inference

When Kofi closed his eyes and played "the beat of his own heart," it shows that he —

- ☐ A. had decided to stop drumming.
- ☐ B. stopped imitating and let his own self guide the music.
- ☐ C. was too tired to keep his eyes open.
- ☐ D. was copying the oldest drummer in the circle.

Q15 RIT 216 Lexile 700L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Drum That Found Its Beat"?

- ☐ A. The best drummers are the ones who copy others exactly.
- ☐ B. You should always do exactly what older people tell you.
- ☐ C. Music sounds best when everyone plays the same beat.
- ☐ D. You find who you are not by copying others but by daring to be yourself.

Passage 4 · Sam and the Science Fair

Sam had always thought of himself as a winner. He won spelling bees, races, and board games, and he expected to win the school science fair too. He built a model volcano, certain it would earn first place. But when the judges came by, his volcano barely bubbled, while a quiet girl named Priya won with a clever project on how plants drink water. At first Sam was crushed. He had never lost at anything important, and he did not know who he was if he was not a winner. For a few days he sulked. Then he noticed Priya carefully watering her plants after school, day after day, taking notes in a worn little book. Sam realized she had not won by luck. She had won through curiosity and steady work. Slowly, Sam began to ask Priya questions, and the two became friends and lab partners. He discovered that losing had taught him something winning never had: that he loved learning for its own sake, not just for the prize. The boy who once needed to win was becoming someone who simply wanted to understand.

186 WORDS · LEXILE 700–800L · RIT 216–220

Q16 RIT 216 Lexile 700L Key Detail

How did Sam think of himself at the start of the passage?

- ☐ A. As a winner who expected to win the science fair.
- ☐ B. As a boy who hated competing.
- ☐ C. As someone who loved plants.
- ☐ D. As Priya's best friend.

Q17 RIT 217 Lexile 720L Key Detail

Why did Priya win the science fair?

- ☐ A. Her volcano bubbled the highest.
- ☐ B. The judges felt sorry for her.
- ☐ C. She had a clever project on how plants drink water.
- ☐ D. She had won every fair before.

Q18 RIT 218 Lexile 740L Inference

When the passage says Sam "did not know who he was if he was not a winner," it suggests that —

- ☐ A. Sam had forgotten his own name.
- ☐ B. Sam had based his whole identity on winning.
- ☐ C. Sam did not like science at all.
- ☐ D. Sam wanted to move to a new school.

Q19 RIT 219 Lexile 770L Cause & Effect

What caused Sam to change his mind about Priya?

- ☐ A. She offered to share her prize with him.
- ☐ B. A teacher told him to be nicer.
- ☐ C. She lost the next contest to him.
- ☐ D. He saw her watering her plants and taking notes day after day, and realized she won through hard work.

Q20 RIT 220 Lexile 800L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Sam and the Science Fair"?

- ☐ A. Winning a contest is the only thing that matters.
- ☐ B. You should never make friends with someone who beats you.
- ☐ C. You should never enter a contest you might lose.
- ☐ D. A hard experience, even losing, can reshape who you are and what you value.